Co-BALT
Process Improvement Initiative

Project Plan: Co-BALT Initiative - Enhancing Organizational Effectiveness

1. Project Name: Co-BALT (Collaboration on Best Alternatives Learning and Technology)

2. Project Goal: Enhance organizational efficiency, effectiveness, and quality of services by fostering a culture of collaboration, continuous learning, and innovation that leverages the principles of the Bottleneck Resolution Method (BRM) to implement process improvement.

3. Project Objectives:

- **Objective 1:** Establish Co-BALT team and define operating procedures within [1 month].
- **Objective 2:** Conduct thorough organizational analysis to identify and prioritize process bottlenecks that hinder key areas within [3 months]. Key areas identified include:
    - Generational Divide
    - Portfolio Management Structure
    - Balance of Regional Autonomy & HQ Guidance
    - Employee Engagement & Workplace Environment
    - Psychological Safety & Open Feedback Mechanisms
    - Civilian Workforce Support Structure
    - Leadership & Supervisor Training & Development
    - Employee Recognition & Awards Program
    - Process & System Auditing & Assessment
    - Knowledge Sharing & Best Practices (Trip Reports, etc.)
    - Meeting Effectiveness & Action Item Tracking
    - Forum Facilitation & Inclusive Communication
- **Objective 3:** Implement the principles of BRM to address prioritized bottlenecks, focusing on solutions that leverage technology, learning efforts, and process streamlining, within [6 months per solution area].
- **Objective 4:** Establish a system for continuous process improvement, monitoring, and feedback collection within the Co-BALT framework.

4. Project Scope:

- **In Scope:**
    - Formation and operation of the Co-BALT team.
    - Comprehensive organizational analysis and bottleneck identification.

  - Development and implementation of solutions aligned with BRM principles.
  - Utilization of technology, learning initiatives, and process improvements.
  - Continuous monitoring, evaluation, and adaptation of solutions.
  - Establishment of a learning organization.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Addressing individual employee performance issues.
  - Implementing major structural changes outside the scope of process improvement.

5. Project Deliverables:

- Co-BALT Charter and Operating Procedures.
- Organizational analysis report detailing identified bottlenecks and recommended prioritization.
- Solution proposals for each prioritized bottleneck, including implementation plans, resource allocation, and anticipated impact.
- Process improvement documentation, training materials, and communication plans for implemented solutions.
- Regular progress reports and feedback mechanisms integrated into Co-BALT meetings.

6. Project Schedule:

- **Phase 1: Co-BALT Formation & Analysis [April 7, 2025] - [August 4, 2025]**
  - Establish the Co-BALT Team
  - Define Operating Procedures
  - Conduct Organizational Analysis
  - Prioritize Bottlenecks
- **Phase 2: Solution Development & Implementation (Ongoing)**
  - [Bottleneck Area - TBD] - Develop & Implement Solution [Start Date] - [End Date]
  - [Bottleneck Area - TBD] - Develop & Implement Solution [Start Date] - [End Date]
  - [...continue for each prioritized area]
- **Phase 3: Continuous Improvement & Monitoring (Ongoing)**
  - Monitor solution effectiveness, gather feedback, and adjust.
  - Identify new bottlenecks and areas for improvement through ongoing analysis.

- Regularly report progress to the Executive Director.

7. Project Resources:

- **Human Resources:**
  - Executive Sponsor: [Executive Director]
  - Co-BALT Team Lead: [Vernon Brown]
  - Co-BALT Members: [Representatives from key departments and functions, subject matter experts, employees with a passion for improvement]
- **Financial Resources:** [Estimated Budget per Phase - TBD]
  - Utilize internal manpower ($.../manpower resourcing)
  - Travel cost ($...)
  - Training ($.../internal)
- **Technology Resources:** [Software/Tools to support collaboration, project management, data analysis, etc.]
  - Utilize internal software/tools if available

8. Project Risks & Mitigation Strategies:

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Resistance to change	Medium	High	Clear communication, executive buy-in, stakeholder engagement, highlight employee benefits, address concerns proactively.
Lack of BRM expertise within Co-BALT	Medium	High	Leverage a BRM consultant or provide in-house training on BRM principles to all Co-BALT members.
Insufficient resource allocation	Medium	High	Secure executive buy-in, clearly define resource needs for each phase, and prioritize solutions strategically.

9. Communication Plan:

- Regular Co-BALT meetings with documented minutes and action items.
- Project updates through email, intranet, or other relevant channels.

- All-hands “town hall” type meetings or presentations to communicate Co-BALT initiatives and successes.
- Feedback mechanisms (surveys, suggestion boxes, etc.) to gather input from all employees.

10. Project Success Criteria:

- Measurable improvements in key performance indicators related to the identified bottlenecks.
- Increased employee engagement and satisfaction.
- Enhanced organizational efficiency, effectiveness, and quality of services.
- A sustainable continuous improvement culture fostered through the Co-BALT efforts.

11. Next Steps:

- Secure final approval for the Co-BALT Charter and Project Plan from the Executive Director.
- Form the Co-BALT team and conduct a kick-off meeting.
- Begin the organizational analysis and bottleneck prioritization.

NOTE: This draft project plan integrates the specific challenges and opportunities outlined in the proposed Co-BALT initiative while adhering to the principles of BRM. By focusing an effort on continuous improvement and collaboration, Co-BALT can drive positive and lasting change within the organization.